BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Checks across the whole treatment course

The columns show the order of care, not equal lengths of time. Confirm who books each check, who reviews it and whom to call if it is missing.

Check	Before starting	Each treatment cycle	Between doses	Decision / response review	Completion / change
Blood count / kidneys / liver	Baseline bloods; DPD before fluoropyrimidine	Repeat before each cycle	Earlier tests if unwell, dehydrated or toxicity develops	Results and recovery guide any delay or dose change	Follow unresolved abnormalities
Symptoms and function	Document existing symptoms and usual activity	Review worst symptoms since the last treatment	Use urgent contacts; do not wait for the next visit	Balance benefit, side effects and priorities	Agree recovery care and ongoing support
Neuropathy / cold sensitivity	Record existing nerve symptoms	Check persistence and effect on daily tasks	Report worsening numbness or cold-triggered throat symptoms	Consultant reviews the oxaliplatin component separately	Nerve symptoms can continue after treatment; arrange review
Heart checks	Review cardiac history; ECG when cardiac function is compromised or clinical findings warrant it. No automatic serial echocardiogram schedule is specified for this regimen.	Ask about new chest pain or breathlessness	Chest pain needs urgent assessment	Repeat heart tests if clinically indicated	Follow any heart problem; no fixed echo series
Response / scans	Confirm cancer setting, disease assessment and intended duration	Review clinical benefit and symptoms	New symptoms may bring review forward	Consultant-directed scans and response assessment	Agree follow-up, completion or another treatment

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00210 v9b · official regimen

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

FOLFOX-4: treatment and checks

Colorectal cancer

Day 1: oxaliplatin and folinic acid, then fluorouracil bolus and a 22-hour infusion. Day 2: further fluorouracil bolus and a second 22-hour infusion; completion around Day 3. A repeating 14-day cycle. For adjuvant FOLFOX-4, NCCP describes 12 cycles; metastatic treatment continues while suitable.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Each treatment cycle	Between doses	Decision / response review	Completion / change
Treatment plan NCCP 00210	Confirm indication, medicines and duration	Give the agreed cycle only after review	Follow pump / tablet and symptom instructions	Continue, modify or stop after consultant review	Agree recovery and follow-up
Blood count / kidneys / liver NCCP 00210	Baseline bloods; DPD before fluoropyrimidine	Repeat before each cycle	Earlier tests if unwell, dehydrated or toxicity develops	Results and recovery guide any delay or dose change	Follow unresolved abnormalities
Symptoms and function NCCP 00210	Document existing symptoms and usual activity	Review worst symptoms since the last treatment	Use urgent contacts; do not wait for the next visit	Balance benefit, side effects and priorities	Agree recovery care and ongoing support
Neuropathy / cold sensitivity NCCP 00210	Record existing nerve symptoms	Check persistence and effect on daily tasks	Report worsening numbness or cold-triggered throat symptoms	Consultant reviews the oxaliplatin component separately	Nerve symptoms can continue after treatment; arrange review
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Response / scans NCCP 00210	Confirm cancer setting, disease assessment and intended duration	Review clinical benefit and symptoms	New symptoms may bring review forward	Consultant-directed scans and response assessment	Agree follow-up, completion or another treatment

What each check is for

1 Confirm the treatment aim

Before starting

FOLFOX-4 may be given after surgery for stage II or III colon cancer, or for colorectal cancer that has spread. Your team explains the aim, alternatives and how benefit will be reviewed.

Ask / act: Confirm the exact indication and intended duration.

Sources: NCCP 00210

2 Review before continuing

At each clinical decision point

Results, symptoms and benefit can change the plan.

Ask / act: Agree who reviews results and communicates the next step.

Sources: NCCP 00210

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-10-25 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.21